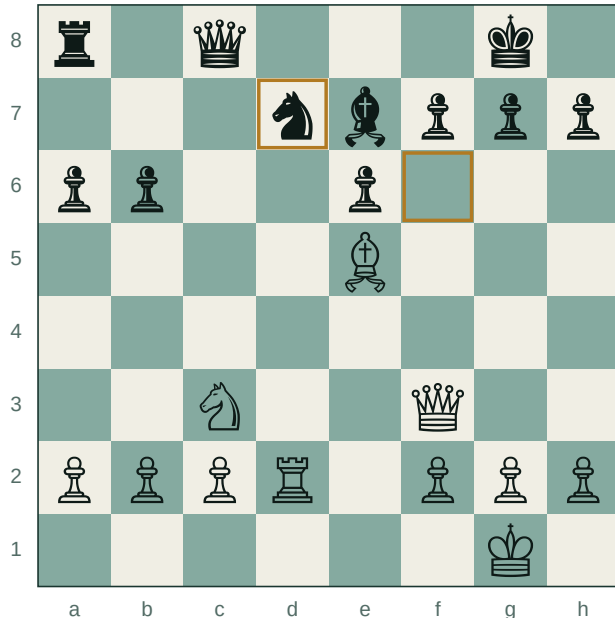


Deflection tactics: White, move 19

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 18...Nd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Rxd7 Qxd7 20. Qxa8+

19.Rxd7 The rook captures the knight on d7. Recorded reply: **19...Qxd7**.

20.Qxa8+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e7. Check for tactical protection.